A CONSULTING PROPOSAL

PADI Website Redesign

Turning First-Time Curiosity Into Certified Divers

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MKTG 262 · Main Course Project Strategy Presentation

AGENDA

What We'll Cover

01

The Client & The Opportunity

Who PADI is, what they need, and what we found.

02

The Redesign

New homepage content strategy and mobile-first design.

03

Why This Approach

The strategic reasoning, backed by outside research.

04

Measuring Success

KPIs, tagging, the data pipeline, and a consultative reporting model.

THE CLIENT

Who Is PADI?



PADI (Professional Association of Diving Instructors) is the world's largest scuba diving training and membership organization, with a global network of instructors, dive centers, and resorts.

Source: PADI.com

186 countries with a PADI presence

~128,000 professional PADI members

6,600 affiliated dive centers & resorts

THE BRIEF

What PADI Needs



A Simpler First Step

A clearer path from first-time interest to booking a course or finding a dive shop.



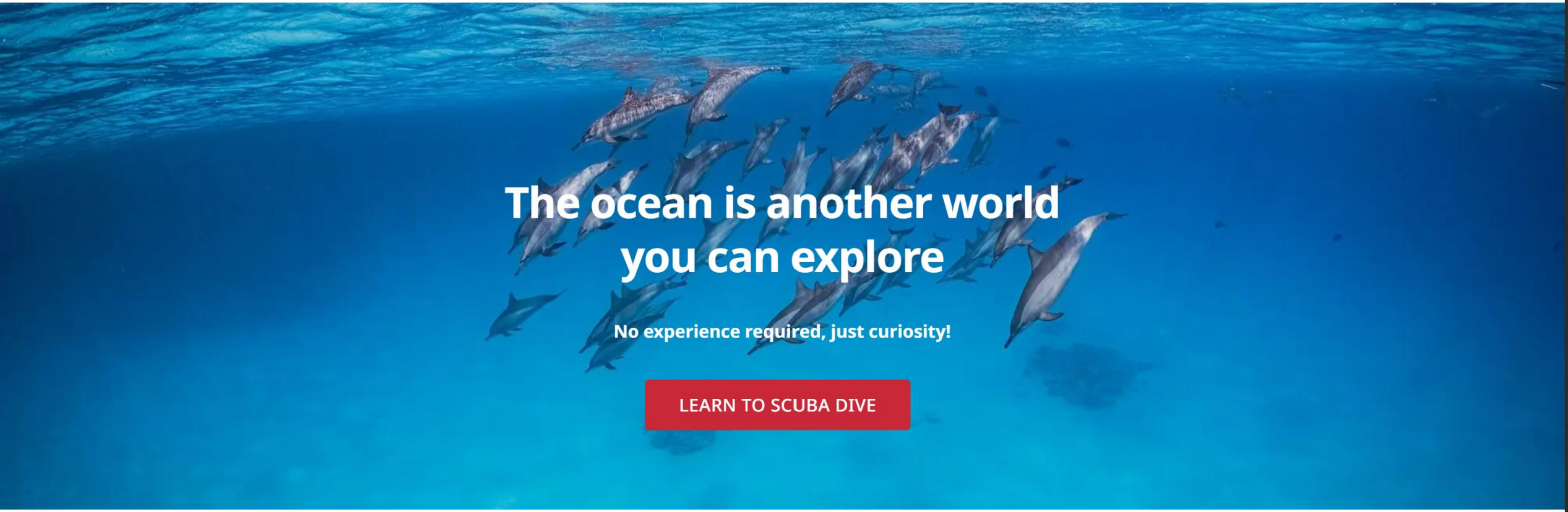
More eLearning Sign-Ups

More visitors enrolling in paid eLearning courses.



More Membership Renewals

More PADI Club members renewing each year.



Seek Adventure. Save the Ocean.

PADI (the Professional Association of Diving Instructors) has been the most recognized dive training organization worldwide for 60 years with over 30 million divers and counting. PADI Dive Instructors undergo rigorous training to ensure your scuba certification class is fun and conducted with care



Open Water Diver eLearning Course

PADI Open Water Diver rating from 74,273 students

4.83 out of 5 stars

eLearning $251.00

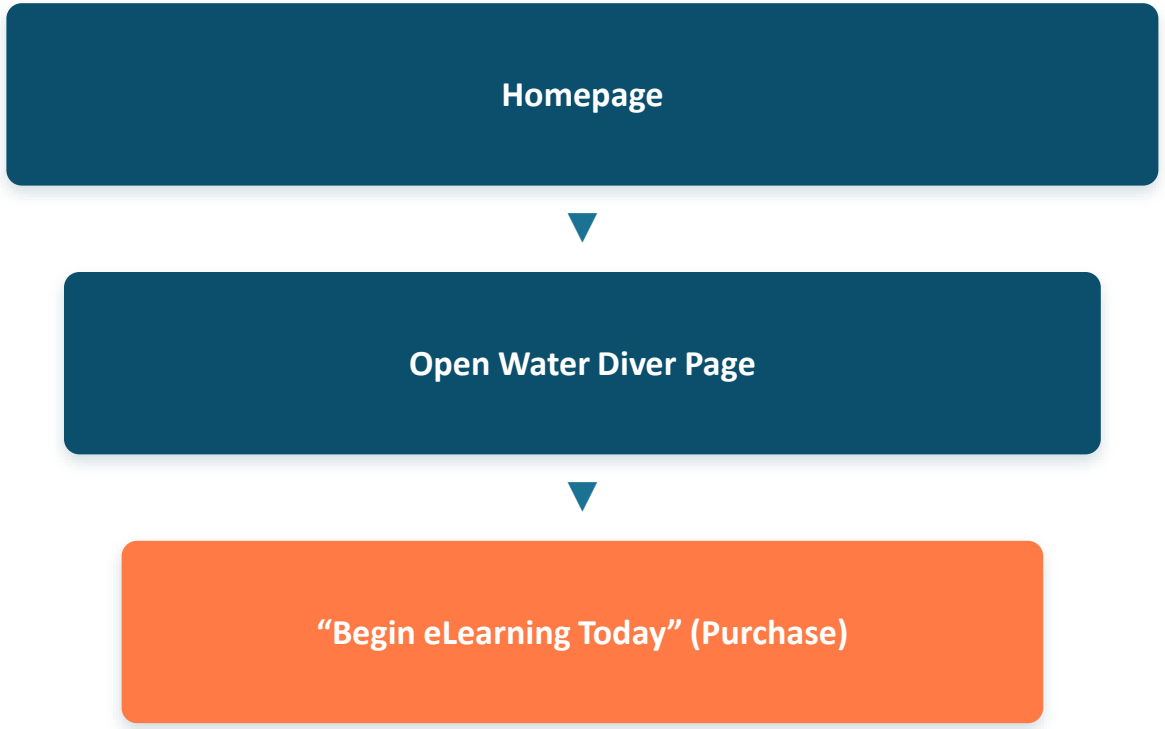
Begin eLearning Today!

One Path In: Straight to Certification

The homepage's main call to action leads directly into the **Open Water Diver** certification page, a full commitment before a visitor has ever tried diving.

The page itself works well for visitors who've already decided to certify: a clear 3-step process linked to the dive locator. The problem is every first-time visitor lands there, ready or not.





The only path currently offered to first-time visitors

BACKGROUND RESEARCH

A Lower-Commitment Option Already Exists

“Discover Scuba Diving” is a low-commitment, one-time pool experience for people unsure about certification, but it’s only listed in the course catalog’s “Other Courses” → “Introductory Experience” section, not on the homepage.

FEATURED ON THE HOMEPAGE TODAY

Open Water Diver

The full certification path. Checkout reads “Begin eLearning Today,” confirming eLearning is the core transaction.

PADI Club Membership

Promoted right after the hero: 20% off eLearning, a free refresher, a magazine subscription. Proof membership is already a priority.

BURIED IN THE CATALOG

Discover Scuba Diving

A one-time pool experience, exactly the low-commitment step curious visitors need. Nested three clicks deep: Courses → Other Courses → Introductory Experience.

Visitors never see it unless they already know to look for it.

Confirmed by PADI's Own Course Pathway



PADI's published course pathway, padi.com

PRIMARY SOURCE

Discover Scuba Diving Is Already Step One

PADI's own course pathway, published on padi.com, places **Discover Scuba Diving** first on the recreational ladder, ahead of Open Water Diver and Advanced Open Water Diver.

The homepage just doesn't reflect that order yet. Surfacing Discover Scuba Diving alongside Open Water Diver brings the site in line with the pathway PADI itself already teaches.

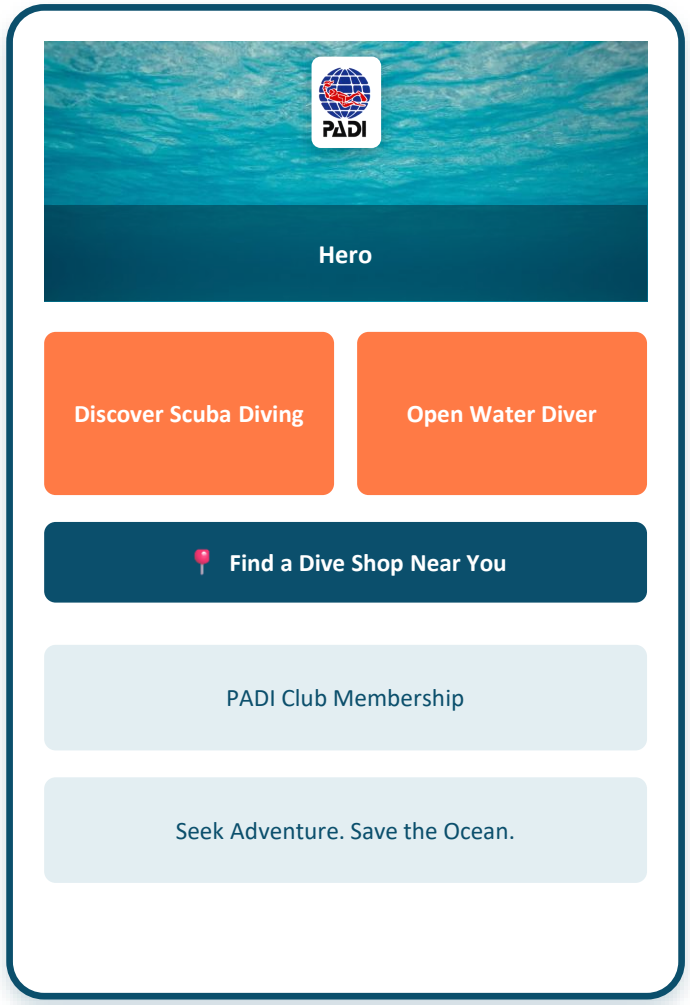
THE REDESIGN

New Homepage Content & Structure

1	**Hero + Call to Action**	Existing ocean photography and hero imagery, unchanged.
2	**Side-by-Side eLearning Links**	Discover Scuba Diving and Open Water Diver, both connected to the dive center locator.
3	**PADI Club Membership**	Positioned after certification content, not before it.
4	**“Seek Adventure. Save the Ocean.”**	Brand / conservation storytelling, extra resources.

DESIGN

Mobile-First Homepage Wireframe



Equal-Weight CTAs

Discover Scuba Diving and Open Water Diver sit side by side, same size, same visual priority. No default path.

Locator, Front and Center

The dive shop locator sits directly beneath both CTAs, one tap away from either path.

Membership Moves Down

PADI Club and merchandise shift below certification content, matching where a visitor is on their journey.

Mobile-First

Curious first-time visitors are more likely browsing on a phone, so the layout is designed for that screen first.

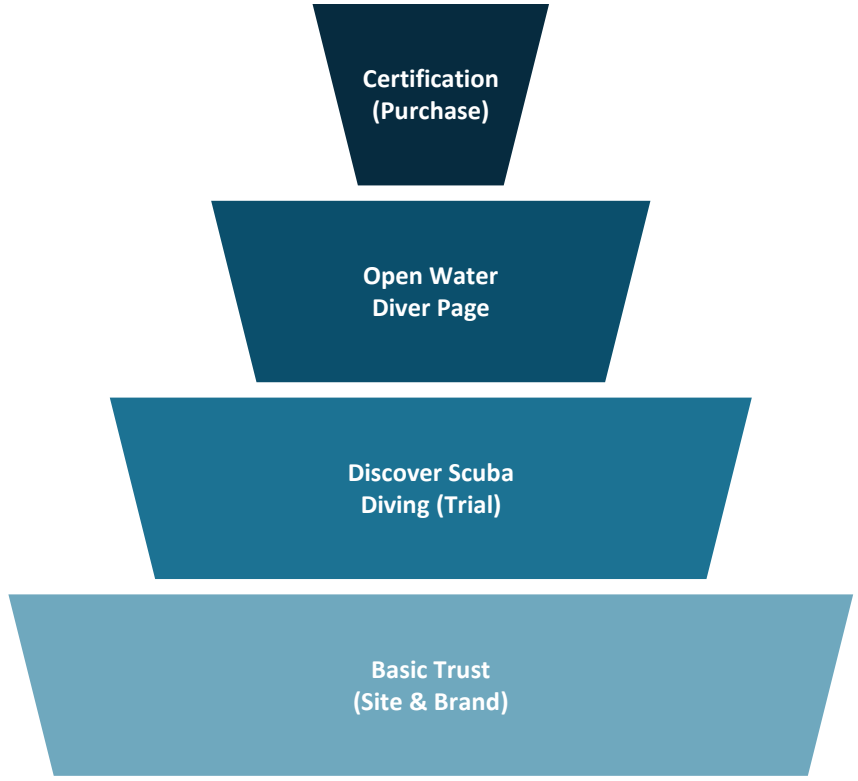
WHY THIS APPROACH

Meet Visitors Where They Are, Mentally

Today's homepage offers first-time visitors exactly one path: straight into an Open Water Diver purchase.

Nielsen Norman Group's research on trust-building finds that sites must earn basic trust with a small, low-risk first step before asking for a bigger commitment.

A Discover Scuba Diving CTA next to certification gives visitors an option that matches where they actually are, instead of forcing a certification decision before they've ever tried diving. Routing it through the locator also strengthens the referral relationship with local dive shops.



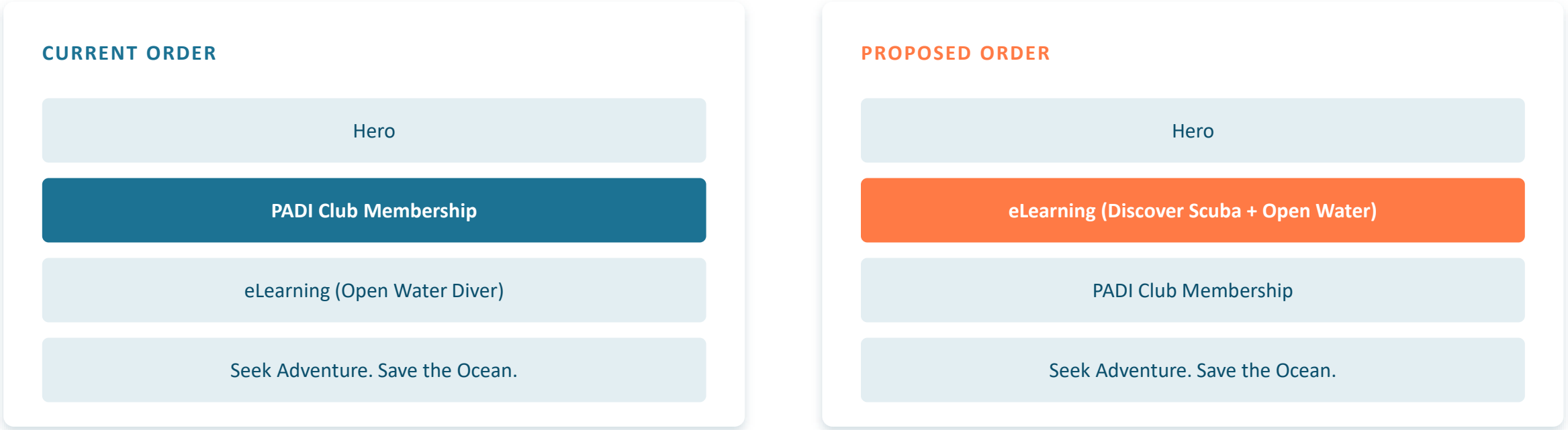
Low commitment ▲ High commitment

Sherwin, K. "Pyramid of Trust." Nielsen Norman Group, nngroup.com.

WHY THIS APPROACH

Sequence the Membership Ask After the Sale

A paid PADI Club membership is a harder sell to someone who hasn't tried diving yet and doesn't know if they'll enjoy it. Moving PADI Club after certification content aligns the offer with visitor intent, showing eLearning and membership in the order that matches their journey.



MEASUREMENT STRATEGY

From Design Change to Measurable Impact

Every change above is tied to a specific metric: tracked through GA4, blended with real dive shop data in Power BI, and rolled into a reporting deliverable that evolves with the program.



KPIS

Primary KPIs: Did the Funnel Change?

- Discover Scuba Diving click rate vs. Open Water Diver click rate
- Dive shop locator usage rate
- Locator-to-contact rate
- Overall course enrollment rate
- eLearning completion rate
- PADI Club renewal rate

KPIS

Secondary Data Points: Context Behind the Numbers

- Traffic source mix
- Mobile vs. desktop split
- Homepage bounce rate
- Scroll depth
- Session duration on each course page

These add context to the primary KPIs: why a number moved, not just that it did.

TAGGING PLAN

How the Site Gets Tagged

GA4 events, deployed through Google Tag Manager, fire on the moments that matter to the redesign:

GA4 EVENT	FIRES WHEN
`discover_scuba_click`	Visitor clicks the Discover Scuba Diving CTA
`open_water_click`	Visitor clicks the Open Water Diver CTA
`locator_search`	Visitor searches the dive shop locator
`locator_contact`	Visitor contacts a dive shop through the locator
`elearning_start`	Visitor begins an eLearning course
`elearning_complete`	Visitor finishes an eLearning course
`padi_club_signup`	Visitor joins PADI Club
`padi_club_renewal`	Existing member renews PADI Club

Every event carries parameters like course_type and cta_position, so we can see not just what happened, but which course and which placement drove it.

One Visitor, One Journey Across Domains

The GA4 property is configured with cross-domain measurement across **padi.com, store.padi.com, and travel.padi.com**, so a single visitor's session isn't fragmented as they move between subdomains.

Without it, a visitor who clicks from padi.com into store.padi.com to check out registers as two separate users and sessions, fragmenting the funnel we're trying to measure. With it, GA4 attributes activity to one continuous journey, so a homepage click can be tied through to a completed enrollment.



Google. "[GA4] Set up cross-domain measurement." Analytics Help, support.google.com.

BEYOND GA4

Connecting the Funnel to Real-World Results

GA4 tells us what happened on the site. These sources tell us whether it turned into a real dive.



PADI Dive Shop Referral & Booking Data

PADI's internal data on dive shop referrals and bookings closes the loop between locator clicks and real-world bookings at a local shop.

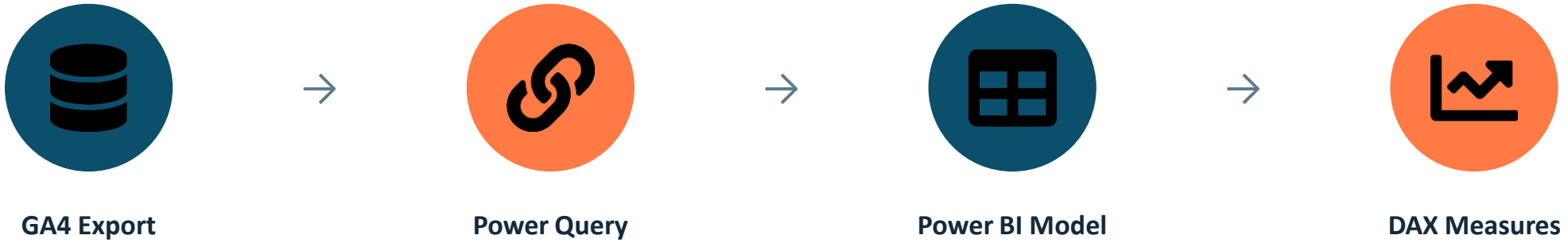


Google Search Console

Organic search queries and visibility data feed the top of the funnel: what people search before they land on padi.com.

TRANSFORMATION

From Raw Exports to Funnel Metrics



- Power BI is the analytics workbench for the whole program.
- Power Query blends GA4 exports with PADI's internal dive shop referral and booking data into a single model.
- DAX measures calculate the funnel KPIs: click-through, locator-to-contact, enrollment, completion, and renewal rates, refreshed consistently.

REPORTING

A Deliverable That Grows With the Program

STAGE 1

Basic Monthly Dashboard

Traffic and CTA clicks: Discover Scuba Diving vs. Open Water Diver, sessions, and channel mix.

STAGE 2

Funnel Dashboard

Tracks the full Discover Scuba Diving → Open Water Diver progression, from click through enrollment.

STAGE 3

Quarterly Consultative Deliverable

Connects web engagement to real dive shop revenue, presented to PADI leadership as a strategic tool.

The same Power BI model powers all three. Reporting matures as more data connects, not as we rebuild it.

SOURCES

References



PADI.com

Client website: homepage, course catalog, and Open Water Diver pages reviewed for background research.



Sherwin, K. (2017). “Pyramid of Trust.”

Nielsen Norman Group. nngroup.com/videos/pyramid-trust/



Google. “[GA4] Set up cross-domain measurement.”

Analytics Help. support.google.com/analytics/answer/10071811

Meet visitors where they are.
Measure whether it worked.

Thank You